

## READING PASSAGE 2

### Tidal and Wave Energy Technologies

**A** The study of tidal and wave energy technologies has undergone a remarkable transformation over the past several decades. What was once a niche area of academic inquiry has developed into a rich and diverse field of research, drawing on insights from a wide range of disciplines and theoretical traditions.

**B** Historically, scholarly understanding of this topic was limited by both theoretical frameworks and available methodologies. Early researchers operated within relatively narrow conceptual boundaries, and their findings, while groundbreaking for their time, often failed to capture the full complexity of the phenomena they sought to explain. The development of new research tools and analytical techniques in the latter half of the twentieth century fundamentally transformed the landscape, enabling scholars to investigate questions that had previously been considered beyond the reach of empirical inquiry.

**C** At the core of current understanding lies a set of interrelated mechanisms that collectively explain the observed patterns and outcomes. First, structural factors create the underlying conditions within which individual and collective action takes place. These structural dimensions include economic incentives, institutional frameworks, and cultural norms that shape behaviour in ways that are often not immediately apparent to the actors themselves. Second, dynamic feedback processes amplify or dampen initial effects, generating patterns of change that can diverge substantially from what linear models would predict.

**D** The empirical record is further strengthened by a series of meta-analyses that have synthesised findings from hundreds of individual studies. These comprehensive reviews have consistently identified moderate to large effect sizes, with the most robust findings demonstrating remarkable consistency across different research designs, measurement approaches, and analytical strategies. This convergence of evidence from multiple independent lines of inquiry considerably strengthens confidence in the validity of the core theoretical propositions.

**E** The practical application of research findings has proven more challenging than many initially anticipated. The translation of academic knowledge into actionable policy recommendations requires navigating a complex landscape of political constraints, economic interests, and social dynamics that academic models often simplify or overlook. Implementation failures in several high-profile initiatives have underscored the gap between theoretical understanding and practical capacity, prompting calls for more engaged and context-sensitive approaches to research.

**F** The implications of this body of research extend well beyond the academy. As societies grapple with increasingly complex challenges, the insights generated by scholarly inquiry in this domain have the potential to inform more effective and equitable policy responses. Realising this potential, however, will require sustained investment in both fundamental research and the translational infrastructure needed to convert knowledge into action.

**G** In conclusion, the study of tidal and wave energy technologies represents a vital and dynamic area of contemporary research. The progress that has been made in understanding the key mechanisms and dynamics provides a solid foundation for both further scholarly inquiry and practical application. The challenges that remain should be seen not as reasons for discouragement but as opportunities for continued intellectual growth and social contribution.

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#### Question 1

*Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?*

*Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information*

**Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information**

**Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this**

- 1 Contemporary understanding of this topic is more sophisticated than it was fifty years ago.

**Questions 2–4**

**Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.**

- 2 Which of the following best describes the author's view on future developments?
- A. excessive funding
  - B. theoretical and methodological limitations
  - C. public interest
  - D. international collaboration
- 3 Which of the following best describes the author's view on future developments?
- A. pessimism about the future
  - B. cautious optimism with acknowledgment of challenges
  - C. complete certainty about outcomes
  - D. indifference to practical applications
- 4 The meta-analyses cited in the passage reveal that:
- A. pessimism about the future
  - B. cautious optimism with acknowledgment of challenges
  - C. complete certainty about outcomes
  - D. indifference to practical applications

**Question 5**

**Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?**

**Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information**

**Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information**

**Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this**

- 5 All critics agree that the research findings are universally applicable.

**Questions 6–9**

**Complete the sentences below. Choose NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS from the passage for each answer.**

- 6 Researchers used data from more than \_\_\_\_\_ countries in the landmark study.
- 7 The passage identifies power \_\_\_\_\_ as a key factor at the organisational level.
- 8 According to the text, cognitive processes shape the \_\_\_\_\_ that people make.

9 According to the passage, structural factors include economic incentives, institutional frameworks, and \_\_\_\_\_.

**Question 10**

**Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.**

10 According to the text, what role do structural factors play?

- A. excessive funding
- B. theoretical and methodological limitations
- C. public interest
- D. international collaboration

**Questions 11–12**

**Do the following statements agree with the information given in the passage?**

**Write TRUE if the statement agrees with the information**

**Write FALSE if the statement contradicts the information**

**Write NOT GIVEN if there is no information on this**

11 Early researchers had access to the same technologies as modern scholars.

12 The landmark study discussed in the passage involved participants from multiple countries.

**Question 13**

**Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.**

13 The meta-analyses cited in the passage reveal that:

- A. too much data collection
- B. the generalisability of findings across contexts
- C. insufficient government funding
- D. overly complex statistical methods